

Analysis I - 6c expanded solution

Product rule: $(uv)' = u'v + uv'$, Chain rule: $\frac{d}{dx}e^{g(x)} = g'(x)e^{g(x)}$.

$$\begin{aligned}
 f(x, y) &= (x + 4y)(e^{-2x} + e^{-3y}), \\
 \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} &= \underbrace{\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(x + 4y)}_{=1} \cdot (e^{-2x} + e^{-3y}) + (x + 4y) \cdot \underbrace{\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(e^{-2x} + e^{-3y})}_{(-2)e^{-2x} + 0} \\
 &= \underbrace{e^{-2x}}_{\text{from } (x+4y)'} + e^{-3y} + \underbrace{(-2x)e^{-2x}}_{\text{from } x} + \underbrace{(-8y)e^{-2x}}_{\text{from } 4y} \\
 &= (1 - 2x - 8y)e^{-2x} + e^{-3y}.
 \end{aligned}$$

Alternatively:

$$f(x, y) = (x + 4y)(e^{-2x} + e^{-3y})$$

Expand first, then differentiate term-by-term (treat y as a constant):

$$\begin{aligned}
 f(x, y) &= xe^{-2x} + xe^{-3y} + 4ye^{-2x} + 4ye^{-3y}. \\
 \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} &= \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(xe^{-2x}) + \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(xe^{-3y}) + \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(4ye^{-2x}) + \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(4ye^{-3y}) \\
 &= \underbrace{(1)e^{-2x}}_{\text{from } (x)'} + \underbrace{x(-2)e^{-2x}}_{\text{from } (e^{-2x})'} + \underbrace{e^{-3y}}_{\text{since } \frac{d}{dx}x=1} + \underbrace{4y(-2)e^{-2x}}_{\text{const. } 4y} + \underbrace{0}_{\text{const. term}} \\
 &= (1 - 2x - 8y)e^{-2x} + e^{-3y}.
 \end{aligned}$$